to be... SMART in English

or The First Bite



TO BE

I am happy.

You are my friend.

The verb “to be” is a helping verb.
It is used to express states, identity, description and more.

1. FORMS OF TO BE

Subject	Present	Past	Future
I	am	was	will be
You	are	were	will be
He / She / It	is	was	will be
We	are	were	will be
They	are	were	will be

2. MAIN USES

IDENTITY
I am a student.

DESCRIPTION
She is kind.

LOCATION
The book is on the table.

TIME / AGE
It is 8 o’clock.
I am 20 years old.

STATE / CONDITION
They are tired.

3. EXAMPLES

PRESENT

- I am hungry.
- You are late.
- He is a doctor.
- We are friends.
- They are happy.

PAST

- I was at home.
- You were great!
- She was very kind.
- We were tired.
- They were at the park.

FUTURE

- I will be ready.
- You will be amazing!
- He will be a great teacher.
- We will be there.
- They will be successful.

4. NEGATIVE FORMS

I	am not	(I’m not)
You	are not	(aren’t)
He / She / It	is not	(isn’t)
We	are not	(aren’t)
They	are not	(aren’t)

EXAMPLES

- I am not busy.
- You aren't late.
- She isn't here.
- We aren't tired.
- They aren't ready.

I’m not a dog!

5. QUESTIONS

Am I?	Yes, I am. / No, I’m not.
Are you?	Yes, you are. / No, you aren’t.
Is he / she / it?	Yes, he / she / it is. / No, he / she / it isn’t.
Are we?	Yes, we are. / No, we aren’t.
Are they?	Yes, they are. / No, they aren’t.

EXAMPLES

- Are you coming? – Yes, I am.
- Is it cold today? – No, it isn’t.
- Are they from Spain? – Yes, they are.

6. CONTRACTIONS

I am → I’m	you are → you’re	he is → he’s	she is → she’s	it is → it’s	we are → we’re	they are → they’re	is not → isn’t	are not → aren’t	am not → amn’t

Remember: To be is special because
it can be a main verb and a helping verb.

FOREST
/'FɒRIST/

HE IS ADAM

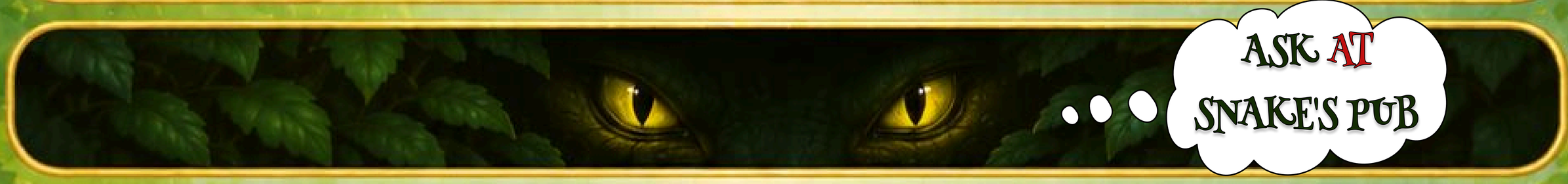
SHE IS EVA

DEER
/DIƏ/

SNAKE
/SNEIK/

RABBIT
/RÆBIT/





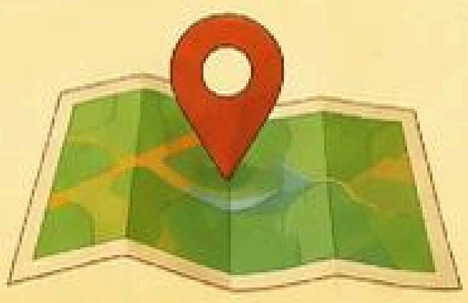
USING 'AT'

1. SPECIFIC POINT IN TIME



at 3 o'clock

2. SPECIFIC PLACE



at the park

3. ADDRESS



at 24 Main Street

4. EVENTS / ACTIVITIES



at the party



The SNAKE'S WHISPER

Rumors
Truth often wrapped in lies

THIS IS A PUB

THE APPLE IS NOT HERE

TO THE OLD ATTIC

BEWARE SWEET WORDS
SMOOTH SCALES

LOOK IN THE OLD ATTIC.

IN

1. inside — in a box
2. in a place / room — in a room
3. in a city / country — in Italy
4. month / year / season — JUL — in July; 2025 — in 2025